

Comprehensive Rulebook: Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Compliance Checker

Sources

- 9 The Legal Metrology (Package Commodities) Rules, 2011.pdf — Full rules text
- LegalMetrologyAct20092.pdf — Packaged Commodities Rules declarations
- LegalMetrologyAct20093.pdf — Maharashtra Enforcement Rules
- LegalMtrologyAct2009.pdf — Legal Metrology Act 2009 (key sections)

Core Thesis

This rulebook serves as the definitive reference for an LLM-based automated compliance checking system. It codifies every mandatory declaration, format requirement, font size specification, permissible error, exemption, and penalty from the Legal Metrology Act 2009 and Packaged Commodities Rules 2011 into structured, machine-readable validation rules that enable automated scanning, extraction, comparison, and report generation for packaged commodity labels.

[Draft] Section 1: Introduction and Purpose

This rulebook is designed as a comprehensive reference document for developing an AI/LLM-based compliance checking system for packaged commodities under Indian Legal Metrology laws. The system will scan product labels, extract declarations, validate them against prescribed rules, and generate compliance/non-compliance reports.

Applicable Legislation:

- The Legal Metrology Act, 2009 (Act No. 1 of 2010)
- The Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 (GSR 202(E), dated 7th March 2011, effective 1st April 2011)
- The Maharashtra Legal Metrology (Enforcement) Rules, 2011

Scope of Application:

- All packaged commodities intended for retail sale to the ultimate consumer
 - Packages up to 25 kg or 25 litres (except cement and fertilizer up to 50 kg)
 - Excludes packages meant for industrial or institutional consumers
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[Draft] Section 2: Key Definitions

Provide the following definitions critical for the LLM system:

- **Pre-packaged commodity** (Section 2(f) of Act): A commodity placed in a package without the purchaser being present, containing a pre-determined quantity
 - **Retail package**: Packages intended for retail sale to the ultimate consumer (excludes industrial/institutional consumers)
 - **Wholesale package**: Package containing retail packages for intermediary sale, or bulk commodity for intermediary distribution
 - **Net quantity**: Quantity by weight, measure or number excluding packaging/wrapper
 - **Maximum permissible error**: Error in deficiency not exceeding limits in First Schedule
 - **Principal display panel**: Total surface area where required information is grouped together
 - **Retail sale price (MRP)**: Maximum price at which commodity may be sold to consumer
 - **Manufacturer**: Person/firm that produces, makes or manufactures the commodity
 - **Packer**: Person/firm that pre-packs any commodity in units suitable for sale
 - **Dealer**: Person/firm carrying on business of buying, selling, supplying or distributing packaged commodities
 - **Lot**: Total number of stored packages OR maximum hourly output of packages on packing line
 - **Standard package**: Package containing specified quantity of a commodity
 - **Complete address**: Postal address of factory, or street name, number, city, state, and PIN code
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[Draft] Section 3: Mandatory Declarations Checklist (Rule 6)

3.1 Declaration 1: Name and Address of Manufacturer/Packer/Importer (Rule 6(1)(a), Rule 10)

What to Check:

- Name and complete address of the manufacturer MUST be present
- If manufacturer is NOT the packer → BOTH names and addresses must appear
- For imported packages → Name and address of the importer must be mentioned
- For commodity manufactured outside India but packed in India → Name and complete address of packer/importer in India on principal display panel

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: At least one entity (manufacturer/packer/importer) name is present
 - CHECK: Complete address includes: postal address of factory OR street name + number + city + state OR PIN code
 - CHECK: If "manufactured by" or "packed by" qualifier is absent, the name is presumed to be the manufacturer
 - CHECK: If brand owner appears as "marketer" → brand owner is responsible for violations
 - CHECK: Corporate name or business name must be used (not trade name alone)
 - EXCEPTION: For packages ≤ 5 cubic cm, a mark/inscription enabling consumer identification is sufficient
 - EXCEPTION: Food articles follow Prevention of Food Adulteration Act, 1954
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3.2 Declaration 2: Common/Generic Name of Commodity (Rule 6(1)(b))

What to Check:

- Common or generic name of the commodity must be present
- For multi-product packages → name AND number or quantity of EACH product

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: Generic/common name is clearly stated (not just brand name)

- CHECK: If multiple products → each product's name and quantity/number is listed
 - FLAG: If only brand name without generic name is found
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3.3 Declaration 3: Net Quantity (Rule 6(1)(c), Rules 11-13)

What to Check:

- Net quantity in standard units of weight, measure, or number
- Must exclude weight of wrappers and packaging materials

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: Net quantity declaration is present
- CHECK: Correct unit of measurement used:
 - Mass (g/kg) → for solid, semi-solid, viscous, or mixture of solid and liquid
 - Length (cm/m) → for items sold by linear measure
 - Area (sq dm/sq m) → for items sold by area
 - Volume (ml/l) → for liquid or cubic measure items
 - Number (N or U) → for items sold by number
- CHECK: Correct unit scale:
 - Less than 1 kg → must use gram (g)
 - Equal to or more than 1 kg → must use kilogram (kg)
 - Less than 1 litre → must use millilitre (ml)
 - Equal to or more than 1 litre → must use litre (l)
 - Less than 1 metre → must use centimetre (cm)
 - Number → symbol N or U
- FLAG: Prohibited words: "minimum", "not less than", "average", "about", "approximately" or similar
- FLAG: Use of dozen, score, gross, great gross
- FLAG: Any system other than International System of Units (SI)

- CHECK: No "when packed" qualifier unless commodity is in Third Schedule (soaps, lotions, cream)
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3.4 Declaration 4: Month and Year of Manufacture/Pre-packing/Import (Rule 6(1)(d))

What to Check:

- Month and year of manufacture, pre-packing, or import must be present
- May be expressed in words, numerals, or both

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: Month AND year are both present
 - CHECK: Format is valid (words, numerals, or combination)
 - EXEMPTIONS (no month/year required):
 - Bidis or incense sticks
 - Domestic LPG cylinders (14.2 kg or 5 kg) by public sector undertaking
 - SPECIAL PROVISIONS:
 - Food articles → Prevention of Food Adulteration Act applies
 - Seeds → Seeds Act, 1966 applies
 - Cosmetics → Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945 apply
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3.5 Declaration 5: Retail Sale Price / MRP (Rule 6(1)(e), Rule 2(m))

What to Check:

- MRP must be printed in prescribed format
- Must include "inclusive of all taxes" or "incl. of all taxes"

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: MRP is present on the package
- CHECK: Format matches one of:
 - "Maximum Retail Price Rs/..... inclusive of all taxes"

- "Max. Retail Price Rs/..... inclusive of all taxes"
 - "MRP Rs/..... incl. of all taxes"
 - CHECK: Rounding rules applied:
 - Fraction < 50 paise → rounded to preceding rupee
 - Fraction > 50 paise and ≤ 95 paise → rounded to 50 paise
 - EXEMPTIONS (no MRP required):
 - Bidi packages
 - Domestic LPG cylinders under Administrative Price Mechanism
 - SPECIAL: Alcoholic beverages → State Excise Laws apply; if state laws don't provide for MRP, these rules apply
 - SPECIAL: Soft drinks/returnable bottles → "MRP Rs...." on crown cap or bottle is sufficient
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3.6 Declaration 6: Dimensions (Rule 6(1)(f), Rules 14-17)

What to Check:

- Where sizes are relevant → dimensions must be declared
- Different pieces with different dimensions → each piece's dimensions

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: For bed-sheets, hemmed fabric, dhoties, sarees, napkins, pillow-covers, towels, table cloths → number and finished size dimensions declared
 - CHECK: For sheets (aluminum foil, facial tissues, waxed paper, toilet paper) → number of usable sheets AND dimensions of each sheet
 - CHECK: For container-type commodities (bags, boxes, cups) → number and dimensions as prescribed
 - CHECK: Where dimensions relate to price → dimensions must be declared
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3.7 Declaration 7: Consumer Care/Complaint Details (Rule 6(2))

What to Check:

- Name and address of contact person/office
- Telephone number
- Email address (if available)

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: Name of person/office for complaints is present
 - CHECK: Address for complaints is present
 - CHECK: Telephone number is present
 - CHECK: Email address (flag if missing but note it's required only "if available")
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[Draft] Section 4: Font Size and Readability Requirements (Rule 7, Rule 9)

4.1 Minimum Height of Numerals — By Weight/Volume (Table-I)

Net Quantity	Normal Case (mm)	Blown/Molded/Embossed (mm)
Up to 200g/ml	1	2
Above 200g/ml up to 500g/ml	2	4
Above 500g/ml	4	6

4.2 Minimum Height of Numerals — By Length/Area/Number (Table-II)

Area of Principal Display Panel	Normal Case (mm)	Blown/Molded/Embossed (mm)
Up to 100 cm ²	1	2
Above 100 cm ² up to 500 cm ²	2	4

Area of Principal Display Panel	Normal Case (mm)	Blown/Molded/Embossed (mm)
Above 500 cm ² up to 2500 cm ²	4	6
Above 2500 cm ²	6	6

4.3 General Font Rules

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: Height of letters in declarations ≥ 1 mm (normal) or ≥ 2 mm (blown/molded/embossed/perforated)
 - CHECK: Width of letter/numeral $\geq$ one-third of its height (except numeral '1' and letters i, I, l)
 - CHECK: Numerals for MRP and net quantity are in contrasting colour against background
 - CHECK: Declarations are legible and prominent
 - CHECK: No declaration requires reading through liquid commodity
 - CHECK: If handwritten/hand-script $\rightarrow$ must be clear, unambiguous, and legible
 - CHECK: Language is Hindi (Devnagri script) OR English (additional languages permitted)
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[Draft] Section 5: Placement and Display Rules (Rule 8)

Validation Rules for LLM:

- CHECK: All declarations appear on the Principal Display Panel
- CHECK: Area surrounding quantity declaration is free from printed information:
 - Above and below: space $\geq$ height of numeral
 - Left and right: space $\geq$ twice the height of numeral
- CHECK: If package has outside container/wrapper $\rightarrow$ wrapper also contains all declarations (unless transparent and readable through it)

- CHECK: For multi-component packages → declarations on main package with info about accompanying packages
 - CHECK: For packages ≤ 5 cubic cm → card/tape affixed firmly bearing required information
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[Draft] Section 6: Sticker Rules (Rule 6(3)(4))

Validation Rules for LLM:

- FLAG: Any sticker altering mandatory declarations → VIOLATION
 - PERMITTED: Sticker reducing MRP (must show revised lower MRP inclusive of all taxes)
 - CHECK: MRP reduction sticker does NOT cover original MRP declaration
 - PERMITTED: Stickers for declarations NOT required under these rules
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[Draft] Section 7: Standard Pack Sizes (Second Schedule, Rule 5)

Commodities and Their Prescribed Standard Quantities:

Sl. No.	Commodity	Standard Quantities
1	Baby food	100g, 200g, 300g, 400g, 500g, 600g, 700g, 800g, 900g, 1kg, 2kg, 5kg, 10kg
2	Weaning food	100g, 200g, 300g, 400g, 500g, 600g, 700g, 800g, 900g, 1kg, 2kg, 5kg, 10kg
3	Biscuits	25g, 50g, 75g, 100g, 150g, 200g, 250g, 300g and multiples of 100g up to 1kg
4	Bread (excl. bun)	100g and multiples of 100g

Sl. No.	Commodity	Standard Quantities
5	Butter and margarine (uncanned)	25g, 50g, 100g, 200g, 500g, 1kg, 2kg, 5kg, multiples of 5kg
6	Cereals and Pulses	100g, 200g, 500g, 1kg, 2kg, 5kg, multiples of 5kg
7	Coffee	25g, 50g, 100g, 200g, 250g, 500g, 1kg, multiples of 1kg
8	Tea	25g, 50g, 100g, 125g, 250g, 500g, 1kg, multiples of 1kg
9	Beverage materials	25g, 50g, 100g, 200g, 500g, 1kg, multiples of 1kg
10	Edible Oils/Vanaspati/Ghee/Butter oil	50g, 100g, 200g, 500g, 1kg, 2kg, 3kg, 5kg, multiples of 5kg
11	Milk Powder	Below 50g no restriction; 50g, 100g, 200g, 500g, 1kg, multiples of 500g
12	Non-soapy detergents (powder)	Below 50g no restriction; 50g, 100g, 200g, 500g, 700g, 1kg, 1.5kg, 2kg, multiples of 1kg
13	Rice/flour/atta/rawa/suji	100g, 200g, 500g, 1kg, 2kg, 5kg, multiples of 5kg
14	Salt	Below 50g in multiples of 10g; 50g, 100g, 200g, 500g, 750g, 1kg, 2kg, 5kg, multiples of 5kg
15a	Laundry Soap	50g, 75g, 100g, multiples of 50g

Sl. No.	Commodity	Standard Quantities
15b	Non-soapy detergent cakes/bars	50g, 75g, 100g, 125g, 150g, 200g, 250g, 300g, multiples of 100g
15c	Toilet Soap	25g, 50g, 75g, 100g, 125g, 150g, multiples of 50g
16	Aerated soft drinks/non-alcoholic beverages	65ml (fruit-based only), 100ml, 125ml (fruit-based only), 150ml, 200ml, 250ml, 300ml, 330ml (cans only), 500ml, 750ml, 1L, 1.5L, 2L, 3L, 4L, 5L
17	Mineral/drinking water	100ml, 150ml, 200ml, 250ml, 300ml, 500ml, 750ml, 1L, 1.5L, 2L, 3L, 4L, 5L
18	Cement in bags	1kg, 2kg, 5kg, 10kg, 20kg, 25kg, 40kg (white cement only), 50kg
19a	Paint/varnish/enamels	50ml, 100ml, 200ml, 500ml, 1L, 2L, 3L, 4L, 5L, multiples of 5L
19b	Paste/solid paint	500g, 1kg, 1.5kg, 2kg, 3kg, 5kg, 7kg, multiples of 5kg

Validation Rule: If commodity is in Second Schedule and packed in non-standard size → must declare "Not a standard pack size under the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011"

[Draft] Section 8: Maximum Permissible Errors (First Schedule, Rule 22)

8.1 By Weight or Volume (Table-I)

Declared Quantity (g or ml)	Max Permissible Error
Up to 50	9%
50 to 100	4.5 g or ml
100 to 200	4.5%
200 to 300	9 g or ml
300 to 500	3%
500 to 1000	15 g or ml
1000 to 10000	1.5%
10000 to 15000	150 g or ml
More than 15000	1.0%

Rounding Rules:

- For quantities ≤ 1000 g/ml: round to nearest one-tenth of g or ml
- For quantities > 1000 g/ml: round to next whole g or ml

8.2 By Length, Area or Number (Table-II)

Quantity Declared	Max Permissible Error
In units of length	2% up to 10 metre; 1% thereafter
In units of area	4% up to 10 sq. metre; 1% thereafter
By number	2% of declared quantity

[Draft] Section 9: Dealer Responsibilities (Rule 18)

Validation Rules for LLM (for e-commerce/retail listings):

- CHECK: No sale above declared MRP
 - CHECK: MRP not obliterated, smudged, or altered
 - CHECK: Package complies with all provisions of Act and Rules
 - CHECK: If tax revised after packing → revised price communicated properly
 - CHECK: Revised lower prices must be charged irrespective of packing month
 - CHECK: Retailers under VAT/TOT must maintain electronic weighing machine (Class III, $\geq 1\text{g}$ division)
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[Draft] Section 10: Exemptions Summary (Rule 26, Rule 3)

Fully Exempt from Rules:

Category	Condition
Very small packages	Net weight/measure $\leq 10\text{g}$ or 10ml
Fast food	Packed by restaurants/hotels
Drug formulations	Under Drugs (Price Control) Order, 1995
Agricultural produce	Packages above 50 kg
Large packages	$> 25\text{ kg}$ or 25 litres (except cement/fertilizer up to 50 kg)
Industrial/Institutional	Bought directly from manufacturer for institutional/industrial use

Partially Exempt:

Product	Exemption
Bidis/Incense sticks	No month/year of manufacture required
Domestic LPG (public sector)	No month/year or MRP required
Food articles	Governed by PFA Act for name/address and date
Cosmetics	Governed by Drugs & Cosmetics Rules, 1945
Alcoholic beverages	Governed by State Excise Laws
Seeds	Governed by Seeds Act, 1966 for date
Packages 10g-20g / 10ml-20ml	Only MRP and net quantity required

[Draft] Section 11: Penalties and Enforcement (Rule 32, Sections 30, 36 of Act)

Under the Rules (Rule 32):

Violation	Penalty
Contravention of Rules 27-31 (registration, advertisements)	Fine of ₹4,000
Contravention of any other provision	Fine of ₹2,000

Under the Act (Section 36):

Offence	First Offence	Second Offence	Subsequent Offences
Non-conforming pre-packaged	Fine up to ₹25,000	Fine up to ₹50,000	Fine ₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000 or

Offence	First Offence	Second Offence	Subsequent Offences
commodity (Section 36(1))			imprisonment up to 1 year or both
Error in net quantity (Section 36(2))	Fine ₹10,000 to ₹50,000	Fine up to ₹1,00,000 or imprisonment up to 1 year or both	Same as second offence

Under the Act (Section 30):

Offence	Penalty
Delivering less quantity than contracted/paid for	Fine up to ₹10,000
Fraudulently receiving excess quantity	Fine up to ₹10,000
Second/subsequent offence	Imprisonment up to 1 year or fine or both

[Draft] Section 12: Inspection and Sampling Procedures (Rules 19-21, Fifth & Sixth Schedules)

Sample Size:

Lot Size	Sample Size
Less than 4000	32 packages
More than 4000	80 packages

Inspection Process:

1. Samples drawn randomly from lot (top, bottom, center, right, left, front, rear)

2. Tests carried out per Sixth Schedule methodology
3. Results entered in Seventh Schedule Form
4. Report furnished to manufacturer/packer
5. If non-compliant: 100% checking required; non-conforming packages cannot be sold until re-packed/re-labeled

Lot Approval Criteria:

- Statistical average of net quantity $\geq$ declared quantity
 - No sample package exceeds maximum permissible error
 - All declarations present on each package
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[Draft] Section 13: Deceptive Packages (Rule 23)

Validation Rules for LLM:

- FLAG: Package designed to give exaggerated/misleading impression of quantity
 - EXCEPTION: Larger dimensions justified for product protection or machine filling requirements
 - ACTION: Deceptive packages must be repacked and re-labeled; failure leads to seizure
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[Draft] Section 14: Wholesale Package Requirements (Rule 24)

Mandatory Declarations on Wholesale Packages:

- Name and address of manufacturer/importer/packer
 - Identity of commodity
 - Total number of retail packages OR net quantity in standard units
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[Draft] Section 15: Import and Export Rules (Rules 25, Section 19 of Act)

Validation Rules:

- Export packages CANNOT be sold in India without re-packing/re-labeling per Chapter II
 - Importers must be registered with the Director
 - Imported packages must bear importer's name and address
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[Draft] Section 16: Registration Requirements (Rules 27-30)

- Every manufacturer, packer, and importer must register with Director/Controller
 - Registration fee: ₹500
 - Must register within 90 days of commencement
 - Alteration fee: ₹100
 - Shorter address registration permitted if sufficient for consumer identification
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[Draft] Section 17: Advertisement Rules (Rule 31)

Validation Rules for LLM (for e-commerce/online listings):

- CHECK: If advertisement mentions MRP → must also declare net quantity/number
 - CHECK: Font size of net quantity in advertisement = same as font size of MRP
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[Draft] Section 18: LLM Compliance Checking Workflow

Step 1: Image/Label Scanning

- Upload product image or label
- Extract text using OCR/vision capabilities

Step 2: Declaration Extraction

- Identify and extract each mandatory declaration field
- Map extracted text to declaration categories

Step 3: Validation Against Rules

- Compare each extracted declaration against the rules in this rulebook
- Check presence, format, completeness, and correctness
- Validate font sizes (if measurable from image)
- Check unit of measurement correctness
- Verify MRP format compliance
- Check standard pack size compliance

Step 4: Non-Compliance Detection

- Flag missing declarations
- Flag incorrect formats
- Flag prohibited words/expressions
- Flag non-standard units
- Flag deceptive packaging indicators
- Flag sticker violations

Step 5: Report Generation

- Generate compliance/non-compliance report
- List all violations with rule references
- Provide severity classification
- Include photographic evidence
- Recommend corrective actions
- Reference applicable penalties

Step 6: Repository and Dashboard

- Store scan results in product compliance history
 - Update dashboard metrics
 - Enable search and retrieval of past inspections
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[Draft] Section 19: Compliance Report Template

The generated report should include:

- 1. Product identification (name, brand, category)
 - 2. Scan date and inspector details
 - 3. Declaration-wise compliance status (Pass/Fail for each of 7 mandatory declarations)
 - 4. Detailed findings for each non-compliance
 - 5. Rule reference for each violation
 - 6. Applicable penalty provisions
 - 7. Photographic evidence
 - 8. Overall compliance score
 - 9. Recommendations for corrective action
 - 10. Digital signature and timestamp
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[Draft] Section 20: Quick Reference — Complete Validation Checklist

#	Check Item	Rule Reference	Severity
1	Manufacturer/Packer/Importer name present	Rule 6(1)(a), Rule 10	Critical
2	Complete address present	Rule 10	Critical
3	Generic/common name of commodity	Rule 6(1)(b)	Critical
4	Net quantity in standard units	Rule 6(1)(c), Rule 13	Critical
5	No prohibited words in quantity declaration	Rule 12(6)	Major
6	SI units only (no dozen/gross)	Rule 13(4)(5)	Major

#	Check Item	Rule Reference	Severity
7	Month and year of manufacture/packing/import	Rule 6(1)(d)	Critical
8	MRP in prescribed format	Rule 6(1)(e), Rule 2(m)	Critical
9	"Inclusive of all taxes" mentioned with MRP	Rule 2(m)	Critical
10	Consumer complaint contact details	Rule 6(2)	Critical
11	Telephone number for complaints	Rule 6(2)	Major
12	Email address (if available)	Rule 6(2)	Minor
13	Dimensions (where relevant)	Rule 6(1)(f)	Major
14	Font size compliance (numerals)	Rule 7, Tables I & II	Major
15	Letter height $\geq$ 1mm (or 2mm if molded)	Rule 7(3)	Major
16	Width $\geq$ 1/3 of height	Rule 7(3) proviso	Minor
17	Contrasting colour for MRP and net quantity	Rule 9(1)(b)	Major
18	Declarations on Principal Display Panel	Rule 8(1)	Major
19	Clear space around quantity declaration	Rule 8(1) proviso	Minor
20	Language in Hindi or English	Rule 9(4)	Major
21	Not readable through liquid	Rule 9(2)	Minor

#	Check Item	Rule Reference	Severity
22	Standard pack size OR "non-standard" declaration	Rule 5	Major
23	No unauthorized stickers altering declarations	Rule 6(3)	Critical
24	MRP reduction sticker not covering original MRP	Rule 6(3) proviso	Major
25	Outer wrapper carries all declarations (if not transparent)	Rule 9(3)	Major
26	No sale above MRP	Rule 18(2)	Critical
27	MRP not obliterated/altered	Rule 18(5)(6)	Critical
28	Registration of manufacturer/packer/importer	Rule 27	Major
29	Advertisement includes net quantity with MRP	Rule 31	Major
30	Net quantity font = MRP font in advertisements	Rule 31(2)	Minor